Steps AI Website: Change Log

Repository stepsaiwebsite06 · Five commits by Prashant Dubey, 22 October 2026 (IST) · From the project cleanup (8495333) to the demo webhook wiring (d1ed6fe)

1. Overview

These five commits turned a site that was built on a generated starter template (vinext + Cloudflare Workers, shadcn UI, Drizzle and many QA files) into a plain Next.js 16 marketing site. They:

- **removed** everything the site does not use (280 files deleted, about 37,000 lines);
- **merged** 50 separate CSS files into one `app/globals.css` and added **Tailwind CSS v4** without changing how the site looks;
- **moved the URLs** to the launch SEO URL map, with one-hop 301 redirects, a trailing-slash rule, `sitemap.xml` and `robots.txt`;
- **made every static file** (images, logos, fonts, favicon) able to load from an external **asset bucket** (your AWS bucket) through `NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL`;
- **connected** "Book a demo" to the webhook form and made "Log in" a real link.

Timeline

Commit	Time (IST)	Message	Size
`8495333`	00:16	all clean ups done	295 files, +4,147 / –37,124
`ebe1c0d`	00:50	tailwind added and custom style css everything removed and top level css moved to global css	57 files, +8,527 / –7,798
`95cd149`	02:08	url's sorted	33 files, +321 / –163
`215285a`	02:32	asset's from bucket origin added	44 files, +268 / –201
`d1ed6fe`	03:01	webhook fixes url	6 files, +27 / –15

The commit before this work is `6dd2d41` (a teammate's revert of the generated concept photos). All of the earlier design and content work (homepage, subpages, case studies, pricing and so on) came from that teammate's commits and is not covered here.

2. Commit 8495333: "all clean ups done"

22 Oct 2026, 00:16 IST · 3 files added, 12 changed, 280 deleted

This commit removed the starter template's tooling and everything the marketing site does not use, moved the project to the standard Next.js commands, and added real blog article pages.

2.1 Removed (by folder)

Folder / file	What it was
`qa/` (132 files)	QA screenshots (.png/.jpg) and QA JSON or notes from earlier design rounds.
`components/ui/` (about 60 files)	Unused shadcn/ui components: accordion, dialog, sidebar, chart, calendar, form, select, tabs, tooltip and others.
`components/v2/`	Old v2 mockups (`mockups-messaging.tsx`, `mockups-product.tsx`, `sections.tsx`), about 3,000 lines.
`components/templates/` old ones	`case-study.tsx` and `channel.tsx`, replaced by newer templates. Also `components/connector-error.tsx`.
`scripts/` (20 files)	Starter tooling: install-ci, pnpm/npm install helpers, copy checks, standalone export, QA runner, sites-env, connector preview.
`build/`, `vite.config.ts`	Vite/vinext plugins and the Sites worker.
`db/`, `drizzle/`, `drizzle.config.ts`, `examples/d1/`	Unused Cloudflare D1 + Drizzle database setup and its example.
`.openai/hosting.json`, `cloudflare-env.d.ts`, `vercel.json`, `.npmrc`	Hosting configuration for the old runtime.
`app/chatgpt-auth.ts`	Mock "sign in with ChatGPT" helper from the starter.
`app/` unused	`focused-inbox.tsx`, `inbox-preview.tsx`, `product-story.tsx`, `use-pinned-tour.ts`, `v2-mockups-product.css`.
`lib/` unused	`links.ts` and the connector files (`connector-context`, `-contract`, `-errors`, `-preview`, `connectors`).
`docs/` (15 files)	Handoff notes, a copy draft (7,018 lines), SEO source notes, image prompts and plans/specs.
`exports/`, `vendor/`	Standalone HTML export and a copy of shadcn's Tailwind CSS.
`public/` (10 files)	Unused starter SVGs (file, globe, window), generation JSON files, and two unused CTA tiles plus `photos/handoff.jpg`.
`hooks/use-mobile.ts`, `components.json`, `postcss.config.mjs`, `tsconfig.tsbuildinfo`	shadcn config and leftovers. PostCSS was added back in the next commit for Tailwind.
`content/channels/chat-page.json`	Content for a channel page that is no longer used.

2.2 package.json

- Renamed the package from `site-creator-vinext-starter` to `stepsai-website`.
- Scripts are now the standard ones: `dev: next dev`, `build: next build`, `start: next start`, `lint: eslint .`. Removed the vinext/wrangler wrappers and the copy-check, export and db scripts.

- Dependencies cut down to `next 16.3.4`, `react`/`react-dom 19.2.6`, `framer-motion`, `lucide-react`, `clsx` and `tailwind-merge`. Removed: radix-ui, @base-ui, shadcn, cmdk, date-fns, drizzle-orm, embla-carousel, input-otp, next-themes, react-day-picker, react-hook-form, react-resizable-panels, recharts, sonner, vaul and zod.
- Dev dependencies: removed vinext, vite, wrangler, the Cloudflare plugins and types, drizzle-kit, json-rpc and react-server-dom-webpack. Kept eslint, eslint-config-next, typescript and the type packages.
- `package-lock.json` was regenerated (about –16,000 lines).

2.3 Config

- `tsconfig.json`: removed `@cloudflare/workers-types` and the `examples` exclusion.
- `eslint.config.mjs`: removed the special rules for the deleted shadcn files.
- `.gitignore`: removed the old runtime entries (`.vinext`, `.wrangler`, `.sites-runtime`, `qa/*.png` and others) and added `*.tsbuildinfo`.
- `README.md`: the starter README was replaced with a short project README (develop, layout, environment).

2.4 New: blog article pages

- `lib/blog.ts` (new): a `BlogPost` type with `listPosts()`, `getPost(slug)`, `getPostById(id)` and `relatedPosts(post, 3)` (same topic first, then the newest).
- `content/hubs/blog.json`: every post got a stable numeric `id` (93 posts).
- `app/blog/[slug]/page.tsx` (new): builds a static page for every post with `generateStaticParams`, and sets the title, description and OG image for each post.
- `components/templates/blog-post.tsx` (new): the article page, with a back link, topic, title, author and date, hero image, summary, a "Read the full article" link to stepsai.co, and "Keep reading" related posts.
- `blog-hub.tsx`: cards now link inside the site to `/blog/<slug>/` with `next/link` instead of going to stepsai.co.
- `app/blog-help.css`: added the `.bl-post*`, `.bl-back` and `.bl-related` styles.
- Removed comments that pointed at the deleted `docs/ai-image-prompts.md` (`ai-image.tsx`, `company-page.tsx`).

3. Commit ebe1c0d: Tailwind added, all CSS merged into globals.css

22 Oct 2026, 00:50 IST · 57 files · 50 CSS files deleted, globals.css grew from 12 to 7,891 lines

3.1 What changed

- **All page CSS was moved into** `app/globals.css`**.** 50 separate files were merged in the same cascade order they loaded in before. Each block starts with a marker comment such as `/* ---- polish.css ---- */`, so you can still see where each rule came from.
- `app/layout.tsx` now imports only `./globals.css`. The 50+ `import "./x.css"` lines, which were scattered through the file, are gone.
- **Tailwind CSS v4** was added: `tailwindcss 4.3.3` and `@tailwindcss/postcss 4.3.3` in devDependencies, and a new `postcss.config.mjs` that loads the plugin.
- `AGENTS.md` and `CLAUDE.md` (the Next.js agent note) were deleted from the repo.

3.2 How globals.css is laid out

```
@layer theme, base, components, utilities;
@import "tailwindcss/theme.css"     layer(theme);
@import "tailwindcss/utilities.css" layer(utilities);

@source not inline("container flex hidden ...");   /* keeps existing class names inert */

@theme inline {                                      /* site tokens as Tailwind utilities */
  --color-blue: var(--blue);  --color-navy: var(--navy);  --color-muted: var(--muted); ...
  --font-sans: Inter, ...;    --font-heading: Manrope, ...;
}

@layer components {
  /* ---- globals.css ---- */   ...
  /* ---- polish.css ---- */    ...
  /* ---- corrections.css ---- */ ...   (and so on for every merged file)
}
```

- **Layer order** `theme, base, components, utilities`: all of the site's own rules sit in `components`, so a new Tailwind utility class always wins over them.
- **No Preflight:** Tailwind's reset is left out on purpose. The site already sets its own base styles, and the reset would change the current look.
- `@source not inline(...)` lists class names that are already in the markup but are not meant as Tailwind classes, such as `container`, `flex`, `hidden`, `sticky` and some arbitrary-value leftovers. Tailwind does not generate those, so nothing that exists today gets restyled.
- `@theme inline` turns the existing CSS variables into utilities such as `bg-navy`, `text-muted`, `font-heading` and the easing `ease-stage`.

3.3 CSS files that were merged and deleted

`analytics-mock`, `app-mocks`, `blog-help`, `book-demo`, `broadcast-page`, `broadcast`, `capability-stage`, `case-studies-clean (1,665 lines)`, `case-studies`, `client-wall`, `company`, `compare`, `connect-flow`, `corrections`, `engage-story`, `final-tiles`, `focused-inbox`, `help-hub`, `hero-cascade`, `hero-channels`, `inbox-finish`, `inbox-preview`, `industries`, `inspiring-experiences`, `integration-pages`, `integrations-hub`, `integrations`, `journey-polish`, `journey-showcase`, `journey-stack-scroll`, `journey-stack`, `motion`, `nav-pill`, `polish`, `premium`, `pricing-page`, `product-story`, `reviews-spotlight`, `setup-journey`, `setup-story`, `site-motion`, `subpages`, `surfaces`, `team-story-options`, `team-story`, `team-switcher`, `typography`, `v2-mockups-messaging`

`(857 lines)`, `v2`, `visual-stories` (all `.css` files in `app/`).

How to add styles from now on: use Tailwind utility classes in the markup, or add rules to the right section of `globals.css`. Do not add new CSS files in `app/`.

4. Commit 95cd149: "url's sorted"

22 Oct 2026, 02:08 IST · 33 files · URLs changed to match the launch SEO URL map

4.1 Renamed routes

Old URL	New URL
`/industries/`, `/industries/<slug>/`	`/solutions/`, `/solutions/<slug>/` (the `app/industries` folder became `app/solutions`)
`/founders-note/`	`/note/`
`/channels/website-chatbot/`	`/channels/website-ai-agent/`
`/channels/whatsapp-chatbot/`	`/channels/whatsapp-ai-agent/`
`/channels/instagram-chatbot/`	`/channels/instagram-ai-agent/`
`/channels/messenger-chatbot/`	`/channels/messenger-ai-agent/`
`/features/whatsapp-broadcast/`	`/features/whatsapp-broadcasting/`

Every link in `routes.ts`, `content/site/nav.json`, `content/hubs/industries.json`, the channel and feature JSON, `not-found.json`, `agent-industries.tsx`, `channel-page.tsx` and `company-page.tsx` was updated to match. The page keys in `lib/content.ts` were renamed the same way.

4.2 New pages

- `app/channels/page.tsx` and `app/features/page.tsx`: new hub pages. Their content is in the new `content/hubs/channels.json` and `content/hubs/features.json`, registered in `lib/content.ts`.
- `HubPage` type: added an optional `cardsTitle`, and `hub.tsx` uses it as the heading above the cards.
- `content/hubs/blog.json`: two new posts (ids 94 and 95, WhatsApp Business API and template categories).

4.3 Pages held back from launch

- New `lib/published.ts` with `publishedUseCases` = sales, support, lead capture and booking agents, plus `isPublishedUseCase()`.
- **AI receptionist** (held until voice calling is live) and **AI marketing agent** (not published) no longer have pages. Their content stays in `content/use-cases/`. They were removed from the nav, `routes.ts` and the "other agents" lists. Cards that would link to them render as a plain <a> with no link.
- **Per-customer case study pages** (`app/case-studies/[slug]/page.tsx`) were removed. The cards on `/case-studies/` are not links for now, and use-case quotes link to `/case-studies/`. The six "<agent> case studies" routes were taken out of `routes.ts`.

4.4 Redirects, trailing slashes, sitemap and robots

- `next.config.ts`: `trailingSlash: true` (every URL ends in /) and `skipTrailingSlashRedirect: true`, plus 24 permanent (301/308) redirects for old stepsai.co URLs. Each one goes straight to its final URL in one hop, and works with or without the trailing slash.
- `proxy.ts` (new, the Next 16 version of middleware) adds the trailing slash with a 308, but only after the redirects have run. Files with an extension, `/_next/` and `/.well-known/` are left alone.
- `app/sitemap.ts` (new): 23 fixed pages plus every feature, channel, solution, use case, compare, integration, help lesson and blog post, all under `https://stepsai.co`, with duplicates removed.
- `app/robots.ts` (new): allows everything and points to `https://stepsai.co/sitemap.xml`.

Old path (redirects from)	Goes to
`/why-stepsai/security`	`/security/`
`/product/analytics-insights`	`/features/analytics/`
`/channels/website`, `/interfaces/chat-widget`, `/channels/standalone-page`, `/interfaces/standalone-page`, `/interfaces/ai-popup`, `/websites/conversation-interface-layer`	`/channels/website-ai-agent/`
`/channels/whatsapp`	`/channels/whatsapp-ai-agent/`
`/channels/instagram`	`/channels/instagram-ai-agent/`
`/use-cases`	`/solutions/`
`/use-cases/sales`	`/use-cases/ai-sales-agent/`
`/use-cases/support-cx`, `/use-cases/operations`	`/use-cases/ai-support-agent/`
`/features/lead-capture`, `/use-cases/marketing-growth`	`/use-cases/ai-lead-capture-agent/`
`/resources/case-studies`	`/case-studies/`
`/resources/ai-guides`	`/blog/`
`/product/ai-agents`, `/product/copilot`	`/`

5. Commit 215285a: assets served from the bucket (AWS)

22 Oct 2026, 02:32 IST · 44 files · every static file path goes through one helper

5.1 The helper

```
// lib/asset.ts
const base = (process.env.NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL ?? '').replace(/\/+$/, '');
export const asset = (path: string) => base + path;

// True for files in public/: /photos, /brands, /images, /industries, /fonts,
// /favicon.svg and /integrations-diagram.png
export const isAssetPath = (value: string) =>
  /^\/(?:photos|brands|images|industries|fonts)\/.+\.\w+$|.../.test(value);
```

- When `NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL` is set (your AWS bucket or CloudFront origin), `asset("/photos/x.jpg")` becomes `https://<bucket-host>/photos/x.jpg`.
- When it is not set, paths stay root-relative and load from the site's own `public/` folder, so local development needs no setup.
- Because the name starts with `NEXT_PUBLIC_`, Next puts the value into the build. Changing it needs a rebuild and redeploy.

5.2 Where it is used

- **Components:** every hard-coded `src="/..."` in 40 component files now uses `asset(...)`. That covers the homepage sections in `app/*.tsx`, `components/premium/*`, `components/site/*` and all of `components/templates/*` (agent pages, channels, industries, case studies, compare, integrations, skills and more).
- **Content JSON:** `lib/content.ts` has a new `withAssets()` that walks the page data and rewrites any string that `isAssetPath` matches. It runs in every getter (`get(slug)`, `getHub`, `getPricing`, `getPage`, `getIntegrationsHub`, `getCaseStudiesHub`), so the JSON files keep plain `/photos/...` paths.
- **Fonts:** the `@font-face` rules for Manrope, DM Sans, Inter and Newsreader moved from `globals.css` to the new `app/fonts.ts`. They are built with `asset()` and added to the page `<head>` as an inline `<style>` by `app/layout.tsx`. A CSS file cannot read environment variables, which is why they moved.
- **Favicon:** `metadata.icons` in `layout.tsx` uses `asset("/favicon.svg")`.

5.3 Bucket requirements

- Upload the **whole** `public/` **folder with the same paths**, for example `public/photos/team.jpg` to `s3://<bucket>/photos/team.jpg`.
- Fonts load from another origin, so the bucket or CloudFront needs a **CORS** rule that allows `GET` from `https://stepsai.co`. Without it the fonts fall back to system fonts.
- Images that use `<img>` do not need CORS. They only need to be publicly readable, or served through CloudFront.
- Blog images still come from `cdn.sanity.io` and are not affected.

6. Commit d1ed6fe: "webhook fixes url" (Book a demo and Log in)

22 Oct 2026, 03:01 IST · 6 files

6.1 The problem

A change in progress had pointed every "Book a demo" button straight at Calendly. That skipped the `/book-a-demo/` form, which is the only thing that posts to `/api/demo-request` and on to the webhook, so no demo request could reach it. The header "Log in" was a `<button>` that went through the click handler, and on inner pages it opened the "Design preview" notice.

6.2 Changes

File	Change
`components/site/routes.ts`	New `DEMO_URL = '/book-a-demo/'` and `CALENDLY_URL = 'https://calendly.com/reshmanth-stepsai/demo'`. "Book a demo" and "See analytics in a demo" use `DEMO_URL`.
`components/site/shell.tsx`	Header "Log in" is now a `LabelLink` (a real `<a href="https://app.stepsai.co/login">`). `SiteFrame` passes `open` (navigate) to the Header and Footer instead of `setRoute`.
`components/templates/book-demo.tsx`	Posts to `/api/demo-request/` (with the trailing slash, so there is no 308 first). The thank-you screen has "Pick a time", which opens Calendly in a new tab with the name and email filled in, plus a "Back to the homepage" `<Link>`.
`components/templates/case-studies-clean.tsx`	7 hard-coded `/book-a-demo/` links now use `DEMO_URL`.
`app/setup-story.tsx`	"See your setup in a demo" uses `DEMO_URL`.
`app/globals.css`	New `.bd-back` style.

6.3 Flow

```
"Book a demo" -> /book-a-demo/ (form) -> POST /api/demo-request/ -> POST DEMO_REQUEST_WEBHOOK_URL
              -> thank-you screen -> "Pick a time" -> Calendly (name and email filled in)
Webhook body: {name, email, company, phone, website, channels, message,
               source: "book-a-demo", submittedAt}
```

6.4 Verified

- `tsc --noEmit` and `next build` pass, and the changed files have no lint errors.
- With no webhook set, the API returns `{"ok":false,"error":"not-configured"}`. With a local test webhook it returns `{"ok":true}`, and the webhook got the full JSON body.
- `https://app.stepsai.co/login` and the Calendly link both return HTTP 200.

7. Environment variables and deployment

Variable	Used by	If not set
`NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL`	`lib/asset.ts`: images, logos, fonts and the favicon load from the AWS bucket. Read at **build** time.	Files load from the site's own `public/` folder.
`DEMO_REQUEST_WEBHOOK_URL`	`app/api/demo-request/route.ts`: where Book-a-Demo requests are forwarded (HubSpot, Zapier, Make, Slack). Read at **run** time.	The form shows "not connected yet" and nothing is sent.

Neither variable is set in the repo, and there is no `.env` file. Set both in the hosting platform, and in `.env.local` for local work:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL=https://<your-bucket-or-cloudfront-host>
DEMO_REQUEST_WEBHOOK_URL=https://hooks.zapier.com/hooks/catch/XXXX/YYYY/
```

Commands

```
npm install
npm run dev     # http://localhost:3000
npm run build
npm start
npm run lint
```

Launch checklist

- Upload `public/` to the bucket with the same paths, and add the CORS rule for fonts.
- Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_ASSET_URL` and `DEMO_REQUEST_WEBHOOK_URL`, then rebuild and redeploy.
- Send one test Book-a-Demo request and check that it reaches the webhook.
- Spot-check a few redirects (such as `/channels/whatsapp` and `/resources/ai-guides`) and `/sitemap.xml`.
- In the browser's Network tab, check that images and fonts load from the bucket host.

8. Known open items

- **Lint:** `npm run lint` still reports 7 errors and 138 warnings in files these commits did not fix. Most warnings are unused variables and `<img>` vs `next/image`.
- **Case study detail pages** are not published, so the cards on `/case-studies/` are not links yet.
- **AI receptionist and AI marketing agent** pages are held back. To publish one, add it to `publishedUseCases` in `lib/published.ts` and back into `lib/content.ts`.
- **Blog article pages** show a summary and link to the full article on stepsai.co. The full article text is not on this site yet.
- **New Tailwind classes** that are on the `@source not inline` list (such as `flex` and `hidden`) are blocked on purpose. Remove a class from that list once nothing in the markup depends on it staying inert.